as she was navigated by Frenchmen, they suffered them to depart with the peltries, telling them that, if she had not been in company with Americans, they would not have injured them, and that, if they found them in such again, they would put them to death. Captain McCurdy likewise was fired upon between Fort Washington and this place, and had five or six men killed and wounded.

"I am directed to write to the commanding officer at Detroit. I have enclosed a copy of that letter."

Governor St. Clair to the commanding officer of Detroit.

MARIETTA, 19*th September*, 1790.

SIR:

As it is not improbable that an account of the military preparations going forward in this quarter of the country may reach you, and give you some uneasiness, while the object to which they are to be directed is not perfectly known to you, I am commanded by the President of the United States to give you the fullest assurances of the pacific disposition entertained towards Great Britain and all her possessions, and to inform you explicitly that the expedition about to be undertaken, is not intended against the post you have the honor to command, nor any other place at present in the possession of the troops of his Britannic Majesty, but is on foot with the sole design of humbling and chastising some of the savage tribes whose depredations are become intolerable, and whose cruelties have of late become an outrage, not on the people of America only, but on humanity, which I now do in the most unequivocal manner. After this candid explanation, sir, there is every reason to expect, both from your own personal character, and from the regard you have for that of your nation, that those tribes will meet with neither countenance nor assistance from any under your command, and that you will do what in your power lies, to restrain the trading people, from whose instigations there is too good reason to believe, much of the injuries committed by the savages has proceeded. I have forwarded this letter by a private gentleman, in preference to that of an officer, by whom you might have expected a communication of this kind, that every suspicion of the purity of the views of the United States might be obviated.

Governor St. Clair to the Secretary of War.

FORT WASHINGTON, 9*th October*, 1790.

On the 23d ultimo, I arrived at this place, and found every thing in a better state of preparation than I had flattered myself with, owing to the prudent care and attention of General Harmar, and the indefatigable application of Captain Ferguson. The militia that had been ordered from Kentucky, appeared on the day appointed, all except one hundred and forty, who have since come forward, and marched to join the army. Major Wyllis, with the troops from the falls, got up on the 22d, and Major Doughty, with part of the garrison of fort Harmar, arrived on the 25th. From the failure on the part of Pennsylvania, the corps would have been rather too weak, and General Harmar was of opinion with me, that it would be proper to ask for a reinforcement from Kentucky, and in virtue of the powers granted to me by the President, I immediately called for five hundred from the counties of Fayette and Woodford, which were the nearest, and also the most populous, and requested that, if it could be done, they might all be mounted; but as the other militia had been for some time here, and were beginning to grow impatient, it was thought best not to wait for the arrival of the reinforcement, and accordingly the corps under the immediate command of Colonel Harding, was put in motion on the 27th, with orders to advance about twenty miles, and to open a road from their camp to this place, for the passage of the artillery. By the accounts we have of the country, after the first twenty miles are passed, it becomes level, and so thinly covered with wood, that there will be little occasion to open roads. On the 30th, General Harmar moved with the troops, three pieces of artillery, and the provisions for the campaign, the cattle and horses for the transportation of the flour having arrived in due season. On the 2d instant, Mr. Frothingham arrived with the remainder of the garrison of fort Harmar, and proceeded to join the army on the third.

I have not heard from General Harmar since his second day's march. The country was then hilly and difficult for the artillery; but some persons who had been viewing the country came in two day's ago, who confirm the account of its very soon becoming level and open. They fell in upon the trace of the army about seven miles from Mud river, and returned upon it. In that distance, there had been occasion to make only one very small causeway with logs. They must be up with Chillicothe before now, and if they have not been opposed there, which I do not expect, as it is situated in a plain prairie. The Indians will be found assembled at the Miami village. Major Hamtramck had orders from General Harmar to move on the 25th of the last month, and the militia would join him in time for him to comply with the orders within a day or two at farthest.

The intelligence I received shall be communicated from time to time, by every opportunity, and by express, if any thing occurs of sufficient importance.

The little army moved in high spirits, and have had excellent weather ever since, one day's rain excepted.

Messrs. Elliot and Williams, Contractors, to the Secretary of War.

14*th October*, 1790.

In consequence of orders received from General Harmar, dated the 15th of July, which we engaged to comply with by the 1st of October, we have, before the 18th of September, furnished and equipped for the use of the army, in the intended expedition against the savages, one hundred and eighty thousand rations of flour, two hundred thousand rations of meat, eight hundred and sixty-eight pack and artillery horses, equipped with pack saddles, bags, ropes, &c. and one horse-master general, eighteen horse-masters, one hundred and thirty pack-horse drivers, all of which could not have been done upon so short a notice as we have had, if we had not employed all our funds, and pledged our credit to the extent, to the people of the Western country, where the supplies were principally furnished.

The expedition, we trust, cannot fail from any default of ours, for we have forwarded supplies in greater quantities than were required of us; and even more than our most sanguine expectations, at the commencement of the business, encouraged us to promise.

Instructions from the President of the United States to the Governor of the Western Territory.—6*th October*, 1789.

TO ARTHUR ST. CLAIR, Esq.

Governor of the territory of the United States northwest of the Ohio, and Superintendent of Indian Affairs for the Northern district:

SIR:

Congress having, by their act of the 29th of September last, empowered me to call forth the militia of the States, respectively, for the protection of the frontiers from the incursions of the hostile Indians, I have thought proper to make this communication to you, together with the instructions herein contained.

It is highly necessary that I should as soon as possible, possess full information, whether the Wabash and Illinois Indians are most inclined for war or peace. If for the former, it is proper that I should be informed of the means which will most probably induce them to peace. If a peace can be established with the said Indians on reasonable terms, the interests of the United States dictate, that it should be effected as soon as possible.

You will therefore inform the said Indians of the dispositions of the General Government on this subject, and of their reasonable desire that there should be a cessation of hostilities as a prelude to a treaty. If, however, notwithstanding your intimations to them, they should continue their hostilities, or meditate any incursions against the frontiers of Virginia and Pennsylvania, or against any of the troops or posts of the United States, and it should appear to you that the time of execution would be so near as to forbid your transmitting the information to me, and receiving my further orders thereon, then you are hereby authorized and empowered, in my name, to call on the lieutenants of the nearest counties of Virginia and Pennsylvania, for such detachments of militia as you may judge proper, not exceeding, however, one thousand from Virginia and five hundred from Pennsylvania.

I have directed letters to be written to the Executives of Virginia and Pennsylvania, informing them of the before recited act of Congress, and that I have given you these conditional directions, so that there may not be any obstructions to such measures as shall be necessary to be taken by you for calling forth the militia agreeably to the instructions herein contained.

The said militia to act in conjunction with the federal troops, in such operations, offensive or defensive, as you, and the commanding officer of the troops, conjointly, shall judge necessary for the public service, and the protection of the inhabitants and the posts.

The said militia, while in actual service, to be on the continental establishment of pay and rations; they are to arm and equip themselves, but to be furnished with public ammunition if necessary, and no charge for the pay of said militia will be valid unless supported by regular musters, made by a field or other officer of the federal troops, to be appointed by the commanding officer of the troops.

I would have it observed forcibly, that a war with the Wabash Indians ought to be avoided by all means consistently with the security of the frontier inhabitants, the security of the troops, and the national dignity. In the exercise of the present indiscriminate hostilities, it is extremely difficult, if not impossible, to say that a war without further measures would be just on the part of the United States.

But, if, after manifesting clearly to the Indians, the dispositions of the General Government for the preservation of peace, and the extension of a just protection to the said Indians, they should contiuue their incursions, the United States will be constrained to punish them with severity.

You will, also, proceed, as soon as you can, with safety, to execute the orders of the late Congress, respecting the inhabitants at St. Vincennes, and at the Kaskaskias, and the other villages on the Mississippi. It is a circumstance of some importance, that the said inhabitants should, as soon as possible, possess the lands to which they are entitled, by some known and fixed principles.

I have directed a number of copies of the treaty made by you, at fort Harmar, with the Wyandots, &c. on the 9th of January last, to be printed and forwarded to you, together with the ratification, and my proclamation enjoining the observance thereof.

As it may be of high importance to obtain a precise and accurate knowledge of the several waters which empty into the Ohio, on the northwest, and of those which discharge themselves in the lakes Erie and Michigan, the length of the portages between, and nature of the ground, an early and pointed attention thereto is earnestly recommended.

Given under my hand, in the city of New York, this 6th day of October, in the year of our Lord one thousand seven hundred and eighty-nine, and in the thirteenth year of the sovereignty and independence of the United States.

The Secretary of War to General Harmar.

7th June, 1790.

The information contained in your letter of the 24th of March last, relative to the depredations of the Indians, is corroborated by several other letters, with considerable additions. The reports of these several events, have excited much disquietude in the public mind generally, and, more particularly, in all men whose views or interests are westward.

A letter from Judge Symmes, dated at Lexington, the 30th of April last, mentions, that you, with some continental troops, and General Scott, with some volunteers from Kentucky, had made an expedition up the Ohio, against the Indians, at or near the Scioto, who had annoyed the boats in descending the Ohio, but without any considerable effect, having killed only four Indians.

The recent hostilities, according to the information, seems to have been committed by the remnants of the Shawanese, and the banditti from several tribes associated with them. Although the said Shawanese, and banditti, aggregately, may not amount, at the excess, to two hundred fighting men, yet they seem sufficient to alarm the whole frontier lying along the Ohio, and, in a considerable degree, injure the reputation of the Government.

To extend a defensive and efficient protection to so extensive a frontier, against solitary, or small parties of enterprising savages, seems altogether impossible. No other remedy remains, but to extirpate, utterly, if possible, the said banditti.

The President of the United States, therefore, directs, that you, and the Governor of the Western Territory, consult together upon the most practicable mode of effecting this object, in such manner as not to interfere with any treaties he may be about forming with any of the regular tribes of Indians on the Wabash.

At this distance, and under the information received, it would seem that an expedition of the nature herein described, might, if conducted with great address and rapidity, be attended with the desired effect.

The troops to be employed on this occasion, to be composed of one hundred continental, and three hundred militia, non-commissioned officers and privates, all picked men, and properly officered.

The militia to be drawn from the nearest counties of Kentucky, to rendezvous at fort Washington, or the mouth of the Great Miami, or such other place as you may judge more proper, to be engaged for thirty days from their arrival at the rendezvous.

The continental troops and militia to be mounted on horseback, and if, in the judgment of the Governor and yourself, that mode of transportation would most probably ensure success, and horses could be obtained in a reasonable distance.

The militia to be on continental pay, according to the establishment, passed the 30th April last; and rations from the time of their arrival at the place of rendezvous.

A continental officer, to muster and inspect the militia on their arrival, and none to be inserted in the pay abstracts, which must be certified by you, unless so mustered. The militia to find their own arms and accoutrements, but to be furnished by the public, with ammunition, if necessary.

The militia officers, non-commissioned officers, and privates, to be allowed for the hire and risk of their horses, and horse accoutrements, such a sum, per day, as the Governor and you shall certify that the nature of the service required; provided, however, such sum shall not exceed half a dollar per day.

The horses to be hired for continental troops, to be on the same terms, or less, in proportion to the risk of the horses, which, perhaps, ought to be on account of the United States, according to the value of the horses, which, in that case, ought to be appraised.

It is presumed, that each horse, besides the rider, ought to carry thirty days bread and pork, or bacon, and about a bushel of corn, or one quart per day, as fodder for the horses.